AIRCAT2404

mbaguru
LEADER IN ADAPTIVE PREPARATION FOR CAT

AIRCAT-2404 Dissection

AIRCAT2404 would have been a decent experience for most of you, especially in the VRC section. A tough but then not so tough test, with no surprise in terms of pattern, it gave you enough room to do better than most of the earlier AIRCATs. Like other not-so-tough tests, this one should also help you understand and realize that you cannot have a specific number of attempts in mind – the ideal attempts and score are a function of the difficulty level of the test. An easier AIRCAT (or actual CAT for that matter) would necessitate a higher number of attempts and also a higher cut-off score and vice-versa. At the same time, it is the accuracy that gives you the edge that's needed to do well, especially on a tough test. And question selection plays a huge role in allowing for better accuracy in a tough test. An easier test implies a lower play of question selection as well.

Let us now look at a detailed sectional analysis in terms of (relative) difficulty level:

	Easy	Intermediate	Difficult	Difficulty Level	Cut off Questions (Marks)
Section I (VRC)	3	10	11	Easy to Intermediate	12 (23)
Section II (DILR)	0	12	8	Intermediate to Difficult	8 (15)
Section III (QA)	6	12	4	Intermediate	8 (15)
Overall	10	35	21	Intermediate to Difficult	29 (55)

A big change for most of you would have been the series of doable RC passages first up with no real speed-breaker as such to disrupt your flow. Even more, a couple of non-MCQ (TITA type) questions were made simpler still with the choices given. The last RC would have appeared to be a relatively tougher one due to the nature of text, but since it was almost 1/3rd the section, it would have been tough to just skip it. To get to the cut-off of approximately 22 marks, a combination of around 12 attempts with 3 wrong would have sufficed. So, you could have skipped any one of the RC passages or some questions in each RC.

The DILR section also had some relatively doable sets in the second half of the section. However, on any tough test/section, your question selection becomes that much more important. So, if you attempted questions quickly like some of the tests wherein DILR was easier, you are bound to have over-attempted and underperformed as a consequence. Investing a few minutes in deciding the right set is almost always a sensible approach. All you needed was to get 6 correct out of 8 attempts to get past the cut-off. Think about how easily you could have done that in multiple ways, even if you wasted some time in finding that way.

The QA sections was slightly testing for 2 reasons – one, that it had a higher proportion of tougher questions and two, that it came at the end and followed a fairly tough DILR section, the baggage of which most of you would have carried into QA. These two factors would have caused many of you to attempt and perform well below your levels in this section. But again, just 8 questions (that's around 4-5 minutes per question) with 6 correct would have sufficed here as well.

Overall, while 21 questions are marked as difficult here, the same is in relative terms within the test. The difficult questions on this test might have been closer to the intermediate ones on some of the tougher tests or vice-versa. So, the test was on the tougher side without being as tough as some of the earlier ones.

Tentative sectional and overall benchmarks are given below

	98%ile	95%ile	90%ile	85%ile
Section I (VRC)	30	25	21	18
Section II (DILR)	23	18	15	12
Section III (QA)	23	17	13	11
Overall	60	50	40	33

-AIRCAT Spinner Team (AST)